MMSU's Commitment

Take an active role in protecting and promoting sustainable use of terrestrial ecosystems, responsible land use, and biodiversity conservation.

SDG 15.2.3 · Maintain and extend current ecosystems' biodiversity

Work directly to maintain and extend existing ecosystems and their biodiversity, of both plants and animals, especially ecosystems under threat.

Evidence year: 2025 (calendar year)

Enriching MMSU's 1,068-Hectare Forest Reserves with Native Species

PHOTO TO INSERT

CAFSD graduands planting native trees and bamboo in the University Forest Reserves, Payao and Mabaleng, City of Batac, 2 July 2025.

`assets/forest_reserve_planting_2025.jpg`

`Source: MMSU News, 4 Jul 2025 (article 2468) or MMSU Public Affairs / CAFSD files`

CAFSD graduands planting native trees and bamboo in the University Forest Reserves, Payao and Mabaleng, City of Batac, 2 July 2025.

MMSU manages Forest Reserve Areas in Barangays Lubbot and Payao, City of Batac, covering a total of 1,068.13 hectares, where the university's forestry and agroforestry research is set up. The university maintains and extends these ecosystems with planting stock raised in its own nurseries, the MMSU Central Nursery and the MMSU Bamboo Nursery.

On July 2, 2025, 230 CAFSD graduating students enriched the reserves with 120 seedlings of the native dipterocarps guijo and yakal in Payao and 130 propagules of kawayan tinik, machiku and giant bamboo in Mabaleng. The activity was led by CAFSD OIC-Dean Charlie Batin with the MMSU Bamboo Research and Development Center.

Source

- MMSU Research Directorate, Station Profile https://research.mmsu.edu.ph/about/station-profile
- MMSU News, "CAFSD graduands plant trees, bamboos in Batac forest reserves," 4 July 2025 https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/article/news/2468/cafsd-graduands-plant-trees-bamboos-in-batac-forest-reserves

Conserving Ilocos Indigenous Food Plants In Situ, Ex Situ and Circa Situ



Partners receive indigenous food plant planting materials for the Community Foodscapes and Seedbanks, World Food Day 2025.

Through its Indigenous Food Plants (IFP) Program, MMSU conserves the wild and neglected food plants of Ilocos Norte, 46 of which were documented by the program in seven towns of the province. The program follows a triad of conservation approaches: an IFP Botanical Garden for ex situ conservation, a himbabao (alukon) genebank at the MMSU Forest Reserve, circa situ cultivation of wild yams, and the integration of IFPs into community foodscapes.

In October 2025, in celebration of World Food Day, the MMSU Extension and Research Directorates established the second batch of Community Foodscapes and Seedbanks for Indigenous Food Plants with local government units and schools, at Eladio V. Barangan Memorial Elementary School in San Nicolas, Ilocos Norte. The foodscape sites serve as seedbanks and learning gardens, and partner communities receive planting materials and technical assistance to cultivate kapaskapas, alokon, pako, dalayap, wild singkamas and roselle.

The IFP Program was adopted by the Regional Development Council of Region 1 as its first research and development initiative, and a study on the program by Dr. Menisa A. Antonio and co-authors won Best Paper in the Sustainable and Smart Agri-Aquaculture and Climate Resilience category of the SUC-ACAP 2025 Biennial Conference, held August 27–29, 2025, in Tagbilaran City, Bohol.

Source

- MMSU Research Directorate, “MMSU research on indigenous food plants wins best paper at SUC-ACAP 2025 conference” https://research.mmsu.edu.ph/news/details/mmsu-research-on-indigenous-food-plants-wins-best-paper-at-suc-acap-2025-conference
- MMSU Extension Directorate, “MMSU expands indigenous food plant seedbanks and foodscapes in LGUs,” October 2025 https://extension.mmsu.edu.ph/news/show/389/mmsu-expands-indigenous-food-plant-seedbanks-and-foodscapes-in-lgus
- MMSU SDG 15 Life on Land report (2025), Office of Sustainability and Futures Thinking

A New Bambusetum in Barangay Aglipay, Pinili

PHOTO TO INSERT

Bamboo propagation, nursery and plantation management training and bambusetum establishment, Barangay Aglipay, Pinili, 2025.

`assets/pinili_bamboo_2025.jpg`

`Source: MMSU News, 3 Sep 2025, or the Extension Directorate`

Bamboo propagation, nursery and plantation management training and bambusetum establishment, Barangay Aglipay, Pinili, 2025.

During a two-day bamboo production training in 2025, the MMSU Extension Directorate and CAFSD, with Barangay Aglipay, Pinili, and the support of ILAARRDEC, worked with 46 farmers, local leaders and community members to establish a new bambusetum, a collection of bamboo species, in Barangay Aglipay. The training covered bamboo propagation, nursery establishment and plantation management.

Source

- MMSU News, “Sustainable livelihood: MMSU, ILAARRDEC hold bamboo training in Pinili,” 3 September 2025 https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/news/sustainable-livelihood-mmsu-ilaarrdec-hold-bamboo-training-in-pinili

Nature-based Solutions to Restore Mangrove Ecosystems in Badoc and Currimao



Project site in Badoc, Ilocos Norte. (Image credit: TTPD, DOST-PCAARRD)



Project Leader Dr. Arlene L. Gonzales presents the project at its launch, MMSU Review Center, 27 June 2024. (Image credit: TTPD, DOST-PCAARRD)

MMSU leads the DOST-PCAARRD-funded project "Nature-based Solutions (NbS) for Sustainable Mangrove Management and Resilient Coastal Communities Through Innovative Green Engineering Approach," implemented from May 1, 2024 to April 30, 2026 under Project Leader Dr. Arlene L. Gonzales. Launched on June 27, 2024 at the MMSU Review Center, the project works in Badoc and Currimao, Ilocos Norte, with DENR-PENRO Ilocos Norte, the Provincial Government of Ilocos Norte, the LGUs of Badoc and Currimao, and local communities.

The project addresses the poor hydrological conditions that keep young mangrove propagules from surviving, using technology-assisted plantations and locally available, ecologically friendly materials, including bamboo-engineered structures that protect young mangroves and improve their survival. In 2025 MMSU and DENR Region 1 met at ILAARRDEC to advance the work; DENR officials pledged technical support and active participation in restoration, monitoring and evaluation, building on a memorandum of understanding signed in October 2024.

Source

- DOST-PCAARRD, "DOST-PCAARRD, MMSU launch nature-based solutions project on mangrove management in Ilocos Norte," 7 August 2024 https://www.pcaarrd.dost.gov.ph/index.php/quick-information-dispatch-qid-articles/dost-pcaarrd-mmsu-launch-nature-based-solutions-project-on-mangrove-management-in-ilocos-norte
- MMSU SDG 15 Life on Land report (2025), Office of Sustainability and Futures Thinking